

games such as FIFA 2003 and Need For Speed HP2 are rather sluggish. I don't have an AGP slot, so I can't install an AGP graphics card. Can I add a PCI graphics card to play these games? If so, please give me a list of the best cards available.

Ravi

A Unfortunately, PCI 3D accelerators have been dead for some time now. Hardly anybody buys them, as AGP has completely overtaken the graphics card market. You'll really have to search hard to find a suitable card. Some time ago, Visiontek offered a PCI card based on the GeForce2 GTS chipset. This would do nicely for the games you wish to play. Another PCI card worth looking for is the PowerVR Kyro. Happy hunting and best of luck!

Q I stay in Mumbai. Could you please recommend a good service centre or technician who won't insist on me signing a yearly contract to make home visits? My system is three years old, and it's been showing the wrong time since the last two months. I believe this problem can be solved by replacing the CMOS battery. But according to my vendor-my system is assembled-this is a crystal oscillator problem. Is that true? Can a motherboard fault cause the wrong time to show up in the system tray? Since I haven't signed a yearly contract with my vendor, he will not be sending a technician for inspection of the fault.

Ashar Bhavesh

A Firstly, sorry—we can't recommend any company or individuals to you. But regarding the CMOS battery, you can boot your machine without the CMOS battery. The only difference would be that the machine will generate a CMOS checksum error, and you would have to press [F1] each time you restart. Also, if the CMOS battery is at fault, it will not be able to retain the changes made to the time. Replacing the battery is not difficult. Open the cabinet, locate the old battery, remove it, and insert the new one. A CMOS battery costs around Rs 20. If the problem is not rectified after replacing the battery, then it might be due to the oscillator, in which case you'll have to take the motherboard to a service centre.